

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

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PRODUCT: Click&Go

TASK: Evaluating the Booking App

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

I found out that the user should always be informed of what is happening on the application. So, I noticed when searching for a bus, the user might definitely wonder if the app is frozen because the list doesn't appear instantly.

Recommendations

As a developer, we should add loading animation or a "Searching" message so that the user knows our app is working.

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

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3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

Our booking application doesn't have an emergency exit so if a user accidentally starts a booking, they will need a fast way to stop.

Recommendations

We should make sure that the "Back" arrow/button is always on the same spot as well as the "Cancel" button that will pop up for the user easy to see.

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

For me, I notice that some of our buttons say "Confirm" while others say "Continue" or "Pay Now" which I think for similar actions.

Recommendations

Should use the same word for the same type of action such as "Confirm" on each page so the users don't get confused.

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5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

As we developed this application as a group, when I tried to pick a travel date that had already passed and it worked.

Recommendations

I think we should grey out the old dates on the calendar we added so that the users cannot click it.

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

If the users forgot so easily, on our payment page, I noticed that the users might forget which bus and the time they picked

Recommendations

I will suggest at least showing a small summary of the trip, could be the route, price and time at the top of our payment section.

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7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

The design of our application should be easy for beginners and also fast for the regular travelers. But I think they might find it repetitive when it comes to typing of their name as well as the contact details every single time they book a ticket.

Recommendations

We should allow the application to save details of frequent passengers so they can fill out the form with just one click.

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

I also noticed in the page of "Important Reminders", the several paragraphs of text that can make the user overwhelmed if they are in a hurry to book.

Recommendations

I will recommend using icons together with short bold headers such as clock icon for "Arrive Early" to make the information easy to understand.

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9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

Our application shows generic error if a user enters an incorrect verification code without saying what the user will do next.

Recommendations

Use simple and clear messages like "Wrong code and the message saying please check your email or please click the 'Resend' to try again".

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

The user might be very confused when it comes to the "Cancellation Policy" as they look at their ticket not knowing where they can find the rules.

Recommendations

I suggest that we should add a small button with "Help" or "Info" label directly on the booking page so the users can be able to read the rules without leaving their current task.